5A

GRAMMAR BANK

unreal conditionals

second conditional sentences: *if* + past simple, *would* / *wouldn't* + infinitive

1 If there **was** a fire in this hotel, it **would be** very difficult to escape. 5.14
I **wouldn't have** a car if I **didn't live** in the country.
2 If it **wasn't raining** so hard, we **could get** to the top of the mountain.
3 If I **were** you, I'**d make** Jimmy wear a helmet when he's cycling.

1 We use second conditional sentences to talk about a hypothetical or imaginary situation in the present or future and its consequences.
2 In the *if*-clause you can also use the past continuous. In the other clause you can use *could* or *might* instead of *would*.
3 With the verb *be* you can use *was* or *were* for *I*, *he*, and *she* in the *if*-clause, e.g. *If Dan was / were here, he would know what to do*. However, in conditionals beginning *If I were you…* to give advice, we always use *were*.

third conditional sentences: *if* + past perfect, *would* / *wouldn't have* + past participle

1 If they **had found** the river sooner, they **would** all **have survived**. 5.15
I **wouldn't have got lost** if I **hadn't taken** the wrong path.
2 He **would have died** if he **hadn't been wearing** a helmet.
If the weather **had been** better, I **might have arrived** earlier.

1 We use third conditional sentences to talk about a hypothetical past situation and its consequences.
2 You can also use the past perfect continuous in the *if*-clause. You can also use *could have* or *might have* instead of *would have* in the other clause.
• In the past perfect simple and continuous, *had* can be contracted to *'d*, e.g. *If they'd found the river sooner…*

second or third conditional?

1 If you **came** to class more often, you **would** probably **pass** the exam. 5.16
2 If you **had come** to class more often, you **would** probably **have passed** the exam.

• Compare the two conditionals:
1 = You don't come to class enough. You need to come more often if you want to pass the exam.
2 = You didn't come to class enough, so you failed.

Mixed conditionals
We sometimes mix second and third conditionals if a hypothetical situation in the past has a present / future consequence, e.g. *You wouldn't be so tired if you had gone to bed earlier last night.*
If he really loved you, he would have asked you to marry him.

a Complete the sentence with the correct form of the verb in brackets, using a second or third conditional.

If Tim *hadn't got injured,* he would have played in the final. (not get injured)
1 I wouldn't have made so much food if you'd told me you weren't hungry. (not make)
2 If I were you, I wouldn't lend money to members of your family. (not lend)
3 If Jack were here, I'd ask him to help me. (ask)
4 Joe wouldn't have had an accident if he hadn't been driving so fast. (not have)
5 I'd run a half-marathon if I were a bit fitter. (be)
6 If you had looked where you were going, you wouldn't have fallen over. (look)
7 I'm sure you would enjoy dancing if you came to the classes with me. (enjoy)
8 We'd go to the local restaurant more often if they changed the menu from time to time. (change)
9 Nina wouldn't have gone abroad if she had been able to find a job here. (be able)
10 If you had asked for a discount in the shop, they might have given you one. (ask)

b Complete the sentence using a second or third conditional.

You didn't wait ten minutes. You didn't see Jim.
If *you'd waited ten minutes, you would have seen Jim*.
1 Luke missed the train. He was late for the interview.
If Luke hadn't missed the train, he wouldn't have been late for the interview.
2 Millie didn't buy the top. She didn't have enough money.
Millie would've bought the top if she had had enough money.
3 It started snowing. We didn't reach the top.
If it hadn't started snowing, we 'd have reached the top.
4 Rebecca drinks too much coffee. She sleeps badly.
If Rebecca didn't drink so much coffee, she wouldn't sleep badly.
5 I don't drive to work. There's so much traffic.
I would drive to work if there weren't so much traffic.
6 Matt doesn't work very hard. He won't get promoted.
If Matt worked harder, he would get promoted.
7 We ran for the bus. We caught it.
If we hadn't run for the bus, we wouldn't have caught it. p.49

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